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Write your **student number** in the boxes above. **Letter**

Sociology

Question and Answer Book

VCE Examination – Thursday 13 November 2025

- Reading time is **15 minutes**: 3.00 pm to 3.15 pm
- Writing time is **2 hours**: 3.15 pm to 5.15 pm

Materials supplied

- Question and Answer Book of 32 pages

Instructions

- Answer **all** questions in the spaces provided.
- Write your responses in English.
- Use the additional space at the end of this book if you need extra space to complete an answer.

Students are **not** permitted to bring mobile phones and/or any unauthorised electronic devices into the examination room.

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Australian Indigenous cultures

Question 1 (4 marks)

Examine the public misconception that Australian Indigenous people share one culture. In your response, use examples from Australian Indigenous cultures you have studied this year.

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Question 2 (6 marks)

Representation 1a

There is one thing today we cannot imagine.

We cannot imagine that the descendants of people whose genius and resilience maintained a culture here through fifty thousand years or more, through cataclysmic[1] changes to the climate and environment, and who then survived two centuries of dispossession and abuse, will be denied their place in the modern Australian nation.

We cannot imagine that.

We cannot imagine that we will fail.

Source: Former Prime Minister Paul Keating, excerpt from a speech delivered at the Australian launch of the International Year for the World's Indigenous People, PM Transcripts, 10 December 1992, <www.pmtranscripts.pmc.gov.au/release/transcript-8765> Licensed CC-BY 4.0

[1]**cataclysmic** – large scale

Representation 1b

We acknowledge the Wurundjeri Woi-Wurrung
People as the Traditional Owners of the land
on which the NGV is built.

Source: Acknowledgment of Country, National Gallery of Victoria, <www.ngv.vic.gov.au>

Apply Charles Wright Mills's concept of the sociological imagination to material in Representations 1a and 1b to show awareness of the experiences of Australian Indigenous people.

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Question 3 (10 marks)

Discuss why Australians may have differing views on reconciliation. Refer to symbolic and practical reconciliation in your response.

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Ethnicity

Use the following information to answer Questions 4 and 5.

Representation 2

Now open: The couple behind the Pierogi Pierogi Food Truck open a Polish diner in Brunswick East [Melbourne]

Polish food is hot at Eat Pierogi[1] Make Love. Expect brightly garnished[2] dishes […] and, of course, pierogi at the brutalist[3]-inspired shop.

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Photograph: Jason South

The plan was never pierogi. For Eat Pierogi Make Love founders Guy Daley and Dominka Sikorska, it was always fashion and music, respectively. But when the pair were expecting their first child, they wanted more stability. They came up with a business plan based on one of their first activities as a couple: hosting pierogi parties …

Now, the duo have opened their first bricks-and-mortar joint: the memorably named Eat Pierogi Make Love. The restaurant's arresting name has also become their mantra. 'Making love is spreading love, spreading understanding and spreading joy – that's what we want to do with this business,' Daley tells *Broadsheet*.

They hope the restaurant inspires people to consider Poland – where Sikorska grew up – and Polish food beyond the stereotypes. '[Poland is] not grey, it's not bleak, it's not anything like that. It's beautiful,' says Daley. 'So making Polish food sexy is really what we're trying to do.'

Eat Pierogi Make Love adopts a Polish way of drinking and eating that Daley says is not unlike the experience you get at a Japanese izakaya[4].

The menu puts a youthful twist on traditional flavours and ingredients. The pierogi options, naturally, are plentiful and varied – from traditional pierogi ruskie (potato and cheese) to a deep-fried vegan offering [jalapeño, potato and vegan cheese].

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Representation 2 – continued

The snacky [food] menu includes rainbow pickles, Polish mountain cheese with cranberry sauce, mixed pate on rye, and sauerkraut[5]-and-potato fritters served with sour cream …

The fit-out plays with Polish aesthetics, nodding to brutalist design with its abundant concrete and beige grid tiling. Colourful Polish posters, retro-inspired light fixtures and scattered cobalt[6] menus add colour.

Keep an eye peeled[7] for the restaurant's upcoming Eat Polska Sunday session: an invitation to partake in the Polish Sunday family meal tradition. You can try specialty dishes like kotlety mielone (turkey and pork meatballs with veg and mash) and kotlety schabowy (crumbed pork loin cutlets with young potatoes, salad and kefir[8]).

Source: Adapted from Alice Manderson, 'Now open: The couple behind the Pierogi Pierogi Food Truck open a Polish diner in Brunswick East', *Broadsheet*, 9 February 2024, <www.broadsheet.com.au/melbourne/food-and-drink/article/first-look-couple-behind-pierogi-pierogi-food-truck-park-it-new-polish-diner-brunswick-east> © Broadsheet Media Pty Ltd; reproduced with permission

[1]**pierogi** – Polish dumpling

[2]**garnished** – decorated

[3]**brutalist** – an architectural style from the 1950s and 1960s that is very plain and typically uses a lot of exposed steel and concrete

[4]**izakaya** – a bar serving grilled food

[5]**sauerkraut** – sour (pickled) cabbage

[6]**cobalt** – blue

[7]**peeled** – open

[8]**kefir** – Turkish fermented yoghurt drink

Question 4 (6 marks)

a. Identify **one** example of material culture from Representation 2. 2 marks

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b. Explain how Eat Pierogi Make Love uses Polish traditions to create a sense of belonging for the Polish community. 4 marks

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Question 5 (4 marks)

Explain Stuart Hall's theory of cultural hybridity and explore its connection to experiences of ethnicity using examples from Representation 2.

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Question 6 (10 marks)

Analyse the impact of the media on **one** ethnic group's experience in Australia's multicultural society. In your response, provide a detailed description of the ethnic group, including how it identifies itself.

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Community

Question 7 (4 marks)

Describe how **two** components of ethical methodology are implemented when conducting sociological research.

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Question 8 (6 marks)

Representation 3

Voice of Real Australia: Small town values in the middle of suburbia

It's a town just an hour from Sydney steeped in rich colonial and Indigenous history surrounded by bustling suburbia.

A town consistently stuck in the push and pull between preservation and progress …

Camden is the kind of town where locals still say hello as they pass each other on the street, the business owners always know the best places to go and the pubs are the place to be on a Saturday night.

There's Camden's proverbial jewel in the crown, St John's Church – whose spire can be seen throughout the town, there's an art gallery in the (haunted) historic Macaria building, a museum and plenty more.

The town's annual [agricultural] show's tagline is 'still a country show' …

But the challenge Camden faces is somewhat unique.

Given the town's location in south west Sydney it is surrounded by large-scale shopping centres, huge restaurant precincts and tourism hubs like Bowral, Wollongong and the Blue Mountains are only a short drive away.

So the town's small businesses face the struggle of stiff competition nearby.

At shopping centres there is no need to walk all the way down the street to visit the butcher after grabbing a coffee – everything is in the one place.

And it's easy to choose to dine at a large-scale chain restaurant, the recipes are stock standard, so you know what you are getting every time.

But there's beauty in enjoying a small town.

Source: Kayla Osborne, 'Voice of Real Australia: Small town values in the middle of suburbia', *The Canberra Times*, 29 March 2022, <www.canberratimes.com.au/story/7660569/small-town-values-in-the-middle-of-suburbia>
Story by Kayla Osborne © The Canberra Times/ACM

Identify **one** economic factor and **one** social factor in Representation 3, and suggest how these factors might affect the experience of community in Camden.

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Question 9 (10 marks)

Examine how the concept of community has changed over time. Refer to the theories of Ferdinand Tönnies and Michel Maffesoli, and include examples from material you have studied this year.

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Social movements and social change

Question 10 (10 marks)

Representation 4

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Photograph: Michael Clayton-Jones

Due to copyright restrictions, this material is not supplied.

Source: Adapted from R Dexter, 'How people power saved Fitzroy pool from closure', *The Age*, 7 December 2024, <www.theage.com.au/national/victoria/how-people-power-john-clarke-and-julian-assange-saved-fitzroy-pool-20241203-p5kviq.html>
Photo licensed by Fairfax Media syndication/Nine group

[1]**black ban** – refusal to do something, as a union tactic [2]**rationalism** – efficiency and cost cutting

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a. Describe the type of social movement shown in Representation 4. Use evidence from Representation 4 to support your response. 3 marks

b. Over six weeks, this social movement moved from emergence to decline.

Identify each stage experienced by this social movement using evidence from Representation 4. 4 marks

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c. Examine how power was used by the social movement in Representation 4 to achieve its aims. 3 marks

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Question 11 (10 marks)

Analyse how a current social movement's stage has affected its ability to influence social change.

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End of examination questions

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Extra space for responses

Clearly **number** all responses in this space.

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If you use any additional Question and Answer Books to complete your responses, write your **student number** on the front cover. At the end of the examination, place the additional Question and Answer Books inside the front cover of the first Question and Answer Book.

Assessment criteria

The extended-answer questions worth 10 marks will be assessed against the following criteria, as appropriate:

- explanation and application of sociological concepts, theories and methods
- knowledge and/or analysis and/or evaluation of sociological experience, perspectives and change
- use and/or evaluation of a range of relevant evidence/sources
- synthesis of evidence to draw conclusions

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